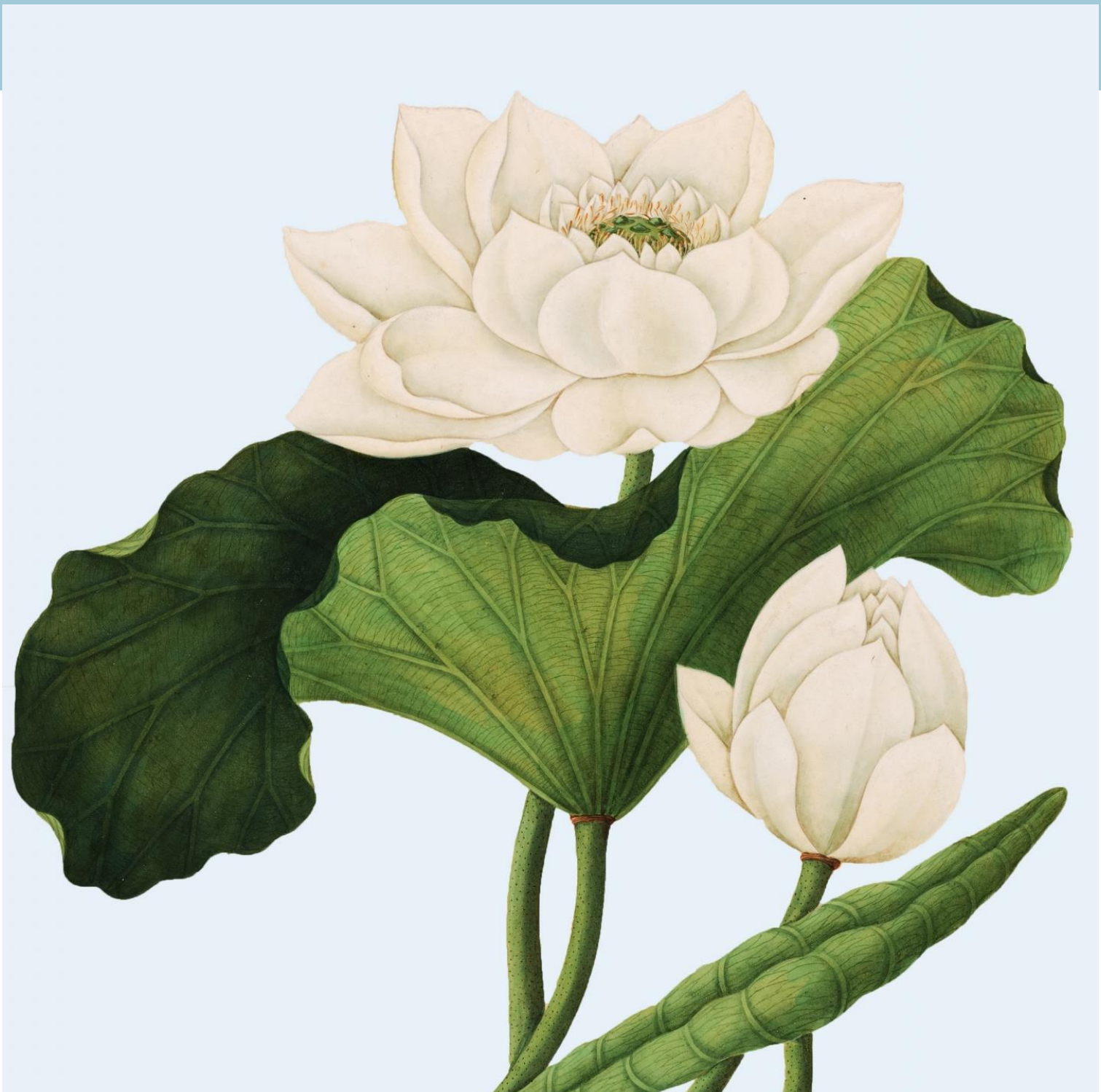
Geidō

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FROM THE AUTHOR

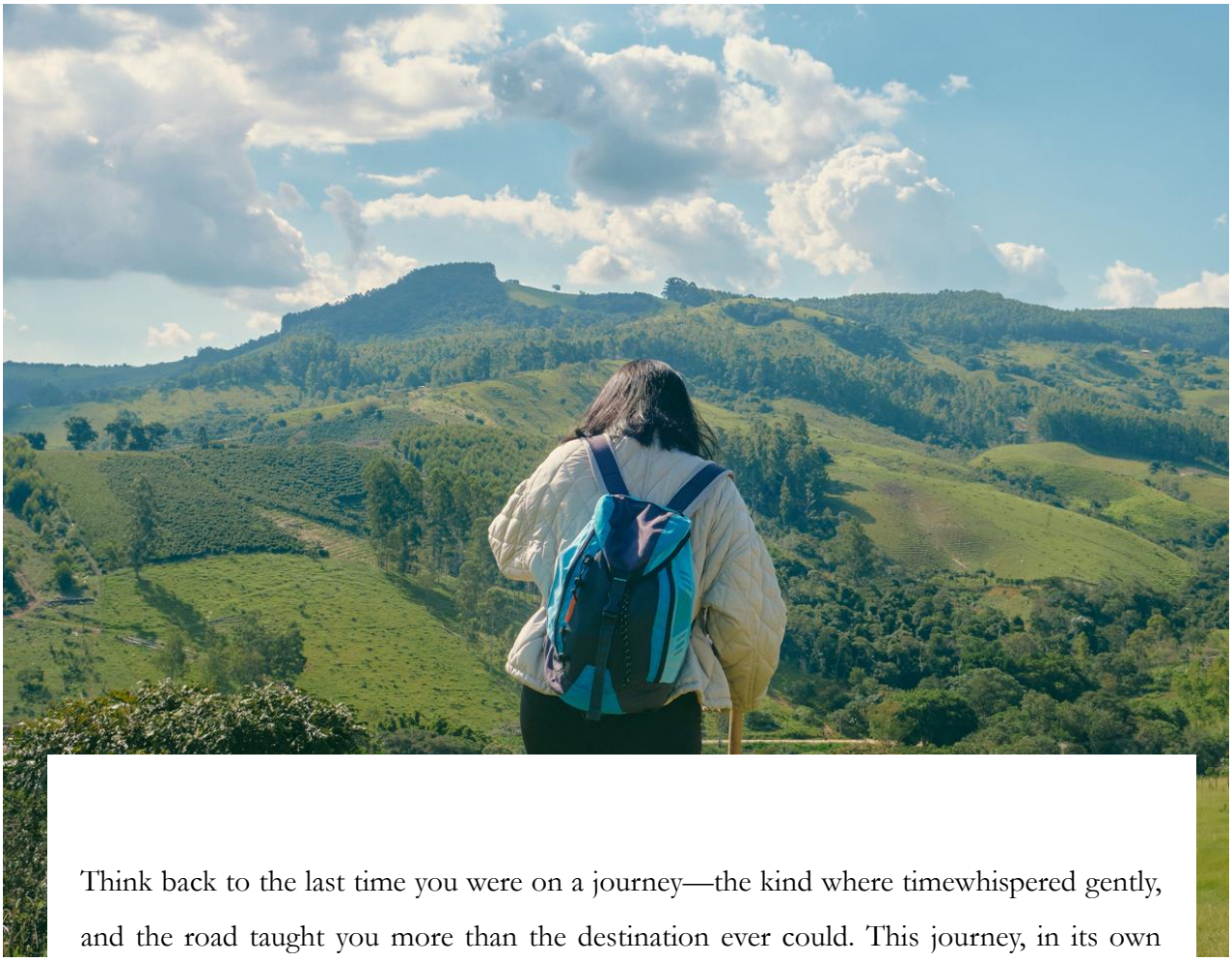
Dear Reader,

This issue of *Geido* is for the learning traveler in you. Life is a journey filled with many paths. Every day, we make choices that shape our future. Some paths are easy, while others are difficult and challenging. The paths we choose reflect our dreams, values, and goals. Sometimes, we may make mistakes, but they teach us important lessons. Choosing the right path requires courage, patience, and determination. We should listen to good advice but also think carefully before making decisions. Every choice has consequences, so we must act wisely. In the end, our choices define who we become and help us build a better future. I dedicate this edition to the learner in my readers.

Monolina Sarkar

Author, *Geidō*

Paths We Choose



Think back to the last time you were on a journey—the kind where timewhispered gently, and the road taught you more than the destination ever could. This journey, in its own slow and sincere way, shows us how adults learn—not in haste, not by command, but through choice, reflection, and the steady unfolding of experience. I often think that the way we travel reveals the architecture of our soul, just as a well-worn suitcase bears the impressions of every path we've taken. We learn like travellers, hesitant and hopeful, with a thousand stories packed away beneath our coats.

Each of us chooses our own road. There is no whistle to signal the start, no teacher with a pointer, no bell that rings. We consult our maps—outdated, folded a hundred times—or the blinking, synthetic calm of GPS voices. But the decisions, the turns, the pace—they are ours alone. (Self-Directed Learning)

And when we leave, we carry more than clothes. We carry the habit of rising before dawn, the knack of fixing what's broken with little more than patience, the quiet confidence of someone who has weathered more than one storm. We do not learn with blank slates. We learn through the textures of memory. (Experience as a Resource)

We move with purpose. Some chase the sea, where they hope to learn stillness; others long for a mountain chapel that only exists in stories, where silence becomes a teacher. There are those who seek a new language in a faraway town, a skill that once seemed beyond reach, or the quiet dignity of building something with their own hands. Some yearn to rewrite their story, to become more than what the past allowed. Others pursue healing, truth, or the courage to begin again. Whatever the destination, whether clearly drawn or faint as mist—it is this vision that keeps the wheels turning. We move with purpose. Some chase the sea; others long for a mountain that only exists in stories. It is both the journey and the destination—that keeps the wheels turning. (Goal-Oriented Learning)

But we do not stop for stopping's sake. A roadside tea shop where the kettle hums, a bookstore with yellowing maps, a place to mend a tire or the heart—these are the pauses we value.(Relevance)

I remember once we took a wrong turn, ended up in a village not on the map. The tire was flat, the language foreign. And yet, we learned how to say "help," how to smile, how to trust. That mistake became the most vivid memory of the trip. (Problem-Centred Approach)

But we only explore when we're ready—when the rain stops, or when the air smells like oranges and history. Until then, we stay still, watching the world unfold from within. (Readiness to Learn)

It is not the souvenirs we remember. It is the conversations, the surprise of a sunrise through fog, the realization that the journey was the destination all along. (Intrinsic Motivation)

There were companions on the road—each with their own shadows and longings. Some played music too loud. Others whispered prayers at every bend. But in respecting their rhythms, we discovered a rhythm of our own. (Respect). We argued sometimes about routes. I liked the backroads, the forgotten paths where poppies grew.

Others preferred highways, sleek and fast. We let the journey unfold in unexpected harmony. And that made all the difference. (Flexibility)

We packed the essentials—snacks for hunger, water for thirst, blankets for cold nights. We marked quiet places to pause and breathe, knowing that preparation was not just about convenience but necessity (Practicality)

Technology, too, had its place. We listened to podcasts, searched for constellations with apps, sent messages home. The digital world became a quiet co-traveller, offering guidance without dominance. (Use of Technology)

Sometimes, we helped our friends. At times, one would spot a missed sign, another point toward a hidden view, while someone else quietly offered a cup of tea without needing to be asked. These small acts of kindness became our shared compass, reminding us that no journey is meant to be travelled alone. (Collaboration).

There were nights around campfires, stories traded like currency. Laughter that needed no translation. A reminder that learning, like joy, is amplified when shared. (Social Interaction)

We stopped often—not out of weariness, but reflection. How far had we come? What had we seen? What had we learnt from the people we had set out with? (Reinforcement and Feedback). We pondered while we met new companions on our way. A woman weaving near the roadside, a song sung in a language we didn't speak, but somehow understood. We bowed to these moments. They reminded us we were guests, not owners. (Cultural Sensitivity).



Each journey whispers its wisdom on the soul that dared to wander.

